

I Tried To Rob a Comic Store, And I Got Blessed With Light Powers?!

Game Design Proposal — TGC GameJam (GDAI & Infinium'26)

Genre: Top-Down 2D Metroidvania — Target Platform: PC / WebGL

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1. CORE GAMEPLAY CONCEPT & MECHANICS

1.1 High Concept

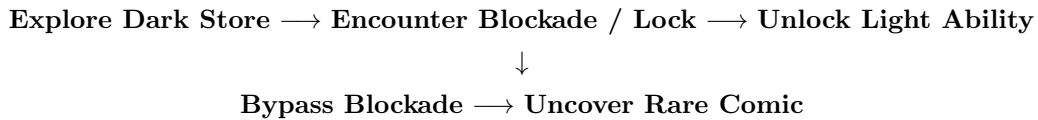
I Tried To Rob a Comic Store, And I Got Blessed With Light Powers?! is a top-down 2D Metroidvania blending dark stealth-exploration with dynamic light manipulation. Players take on the role of an amateur thief breaking into a local comic shop at pitch-black night, equipped with nothing but a weak flashlight. Upon entering, they quickly realize the store is an impossibly vast, sprawling labyrinth. To navigate the darkness and steal ultra-rare comic books, the thief unlocks supernatural "light-twisting" powers that turn illumination into both a navigational tool and an essential key to progression.

1.2 Primary Gameplay Mechanics

- **Pitch-Black Fog of War & Flashlight Mechanics:** The store is completely dark. Players must use a directional beam flashlight to reveal dynamic line-of-sight terrain, environmental hazards, and hidden paths.
- **Light-Twisting Upgrades (Metroidvania Ability Gating):**
 - *Light Refraction (Bending Beam):* Bends light around corners to hit light-sensitive sensors and open locked security doors.
 - *Hard-Light Solidification:* Focuses high-intensity light to project temporary physical bridges across store chasms and structural gaps.
 - *Flashburst (Overcharge):* Disables automatic security systems, blinds camera lenses, and stuns patrolling night-guards.
- **Exploration & Upgrades:** Access to deeper, high-value zones (e.g., *Manga Vault*, *Golden-Age Archives*) is blocked by light-based security doors, requiring specific power upgrades found across the store to breach.

2. GAME FLOW & STRUCTURE

2.1 Core Loop



2.2 Progression Structure

1. **The Infiltration:** The player sneaks in through the back alley using only a weak flashlight beam. Moving past the front register reveals an endlessly expanding floorplan far larger than humanly possible.
2. **Power Awakening:** Trapped behind an active security shutter, the thief discovers an arcane, glowing vintage comic artifact, granting them their first light-twisting capability.
3. **Metroidvania Loop (Exploration & Backtracking):** The player manipulates light to solve environmental logic puzzles, trigger switches across walls, bypass security fields, and collect rare comics.
4. **The Final Heist / Grand Exit:** Mastering all light manipulation abilities grants access to the central vault housing the legendary "Issue #1" comic, leading to an action-packed escape sequence back to the exit.

2.3 Win & Loss Conditions

- **Win Condition:** Secure the target comic books and successfully reach the store's escape route.
- **Loss Condition:** Battery depletion or capture by store defenses, triggering a fast-respawn at the nearest illuminated display stand checkpoint.

3. THEME JUSTIFICATION: COMIC, TWIST, & LIGHT

The game seamlessly integrates all three jam themes into a cohesive, mechanics-driven experience:

3.1 Theme 1: "Comic" (Setting, Objectives, & Narrative Frame)

- **Thematic Framing:** The setting is a comic shop that doubles as an impossible labyrinth, complete with distinct zones like the *Golden-Age Archives* and *Manga Vault*.
- **Collectibles & Progression:** Objectives are rare vintage comics ("Issue #1") that double as lore pickups and spellbooks granting new powers.
- **Light-Novel Style Narrative:** The comedic, manga-style title ("I Tried To Rob a Comic Store...") drives the absurd narrative direction.

3.2 Theme 2: "Twist" (Mechanical Bending & Narrative Subversion)

- **Literal Mechanical Twist:** The core puzzle mechanic is *Light Refraction*—players literally **twist and bend** light beams around corners and obstacles to hit hidden sensors and alter room architecture.
- **Narrative & Genre Twist:** What starts as a mundane late-night store heist takes a surreal **twist** into a supernatural dungeon crawler. Furthermore, traditional stealth tropes are subverted: instead of hiding in shadows, players must actively throw light into the dark to progress.

3.3 Theme 3: "Light" (Core Interaction & Navigation)

- **Primary Gameplay Medium:** Light acts as vision, tool, and hazard. The pitch-black fog of war forces players to use light to navigate, reveal hidden paths, construct hard-light bridges, and disable security systems.